

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
HEADQUARTERS, 403RD MILITARY POLICE
PRISONER OF WAR CAMP
OPERATION DESERT STORM
APO, NEW YORK 09616

AFKB-AC-CA

2 April 1991

MEMORANDUM FOR COMMANDER, 800TH MP BRIGADE, KHOBAR VILLAGE, SAUDI ARABIA

SUBJECT: After Action Report, 403rd MP PW Camp

1. Description of the Operation: The 403rd MP PW Camp was mobilized 6 December 1990 and assigned to the 800th MP Brigade. The 403rd deployed to Saudi Arabia and was given the mission of establishing and operating an EPW Camp with a capacity of 12,000 EPW and being prepared to, upon order, increase the capacity of the Camp to 24,000 EPW. The 403rd arrived in country 15 January 1991; the first elements of 403rd arrived at the EPW site on 22 January 1991. The site survey was completed by the 864th Engineer Bn on 23 January. The first EPW were accepted on 17 February. From 17 February 1991 through 27 February EPW were systematically processed in and then transferred to a Saudi EPW Camp. The 403rd also received EPW transfers from the 401st during this period so they could complete construction on their camp. In a seven day period beginning on 27 February the 403rd received 9,853 EPW. Processing of EPW was a 24 hour per day operation. A total of 9,647 EPW were processed during a nine day period. The remainder were placed in medical channels before they could be inprocessed. Transfer of EPW to the Saudi Camp began on 12 March 1991. On 23 March 1991 permission was received to use EPW labor to dismantle the EPW Camp. By the time the last EPW were transferred to the Saudi's EPW Camp on 27 March 1991, the Camp had been dismantled except for one compound in Enclosure Two.

2. Evaluation Methodology: The evaluation methodology consisted of a review of the Command Report prepared by all staff sections within the 403rd and all subordinate units; a review of Commander's, Executive Officer's and staff logs, and documents received and/or prepared between mobilization on 6 December 1990 and 1 April 1991.

3. Discussion of Key Issues; Summary and Assessment of Progress: Actual preparation for the mission began at MOB Station on 11 December 1991. Time spent at Home Station immediately after activation focused on the move to MOB Station. The important milestones and key issues are summarized and the implications of those issues and milestones analyzed below.

a. The 403rd remained at Fort Riley for approximately one month, from 11 December through 12 January 1991. During this period the unit completed mobilization processing, underwent both required predeployment training and mission training. Required predeployment training was coordinated through Ft. Riley Readiness Group. Mission specific training was coordinated

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through the United States Army Correctional Brigade. The most significant problem encountered at MOB Station involved the shipment of equipment. The 403rd received notification the evening of 11 December that all mission essential equipment had to be loaded by 14 December. The equipment was to be shipped by rail on 15 December to the Port of Houston with 1st INF DIV equipment.

b. The equipment was to be transported via ship to Saudi Arabia. Estimated departure date was 17 December with a mid-January ETA in Saudi Arabia. The timeline described above represented a change. Instead of the week to load equipment we had expected, we only had three days. The loading was accomplished on time; the equipment arrived at the Port of Houston on schedule but sat in port for over a month. The 403rd was in Saudi Arabia before our mission essential equipment even left Houston. This equipment included all vehicles, generators and water buffalos. The fact that we did not have this equipment significantly hampered both the units ability to move to the EPW site and its ability to accomplish the mission. Although we were able to work around this equipment problem, it diverted time and effort that could have otherwise been directed toward mission and resulted in delays that could have been critical to mission accomplishment.

c. A second problem encountered at MOB Station was lack of communication with both the 800th MP Brigade and subordinate units. Prior to mobilization the 403rd was Capstoned to the 300th MP Brigade. Immediately upon notification of pending activation two officers from the 403rd, the S-3 and an Enclosure Commander, were assigned as liaison to the 800th. These liaison officers arrived in country on 10 December 1990. However, communications with both the liaison officers and the 800th were infrequent and unschedulable. This made planning beyond MOB Station difficult. This was a particular problem for the S-4 who didn't know what to order, what was available in country, what the 800th was planning to provide, etc. None of the nine subordinate units assigned to the 403rd were in its premobilized Capstone trace. One of the subordinate units, the 346th Escort Guard Company, also mobilized at Fort Riley, but communication with the other units was difficult. All units were given mission guidance and their readiness monitored. However, lack of dependable information regarding the mission and lack of good communications resulted in inefficient use of valuable MOB Station training time.

d. The mission given to the 403rd was to establish and operate an EPW camp for up to 12,000 EPW and, upon order, be ready to expand the camp to hold 24,000 EPW. When the 403rd arrived in Saudi Arabia on 15 January an EPW site had been selected but construction had not begun. Therefore, the 403rd immediately starting planning for the construction of an EPW camp. The MTOE under which the 403rd is organized is configured to maintain an existing EPW facility. Prior to mobilization the 403rd had been assigned a CONUS EPW mission. Construction of a camp at a remote field site was a task for which the 403rd was neither well equipped nor well trained. In spite of a lack of preparation and training, construction of the camp by

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the 403rd and its subordinate units went remarkably well. Work was begun on 25 January and the first EPW were accepted on 17 February.

e. Construction work on the camp was slowed by a number of factors not under the direct control of the 403rd. These factors included the relatively low priority given the EPW mission. The 403rd was the first EPW camp in country but did not arrive until 15 January, two days before the air war started. The 401st arrived two days later. The Class IV supplies needed to construct the camp were not yet available. Our mission essential MTOE equipment which left our MOB station on 15 December 1990 was still sitting in Houston waiting to be shipped. The only equipment the 403rd had was the TA-50 and NBC carried on the airplane. As soon as the air war began, US troops began taking EPW and it became necessary to get at least one camp at each site operational as quickly as possible. In the East site, that camp was identified as the 401st, the logical choice because their MTOE equipment was already in country. Consequently, the 401st was given priority for Class IV material and engineer support. The 403rd was also tasked to provide up to two platoons to help the 401st build their camp and did so from 20 January, two days before the 403rd advance party arrived on site, through 11 February. The 403rd also supported the 401st by taking on supplemental missions that the 401st had been performing, thus freeing 401st personnel to work on their camp. These missions included a port security mission, an embassy mission and security of the JIF. These missions were performed in addition to the supplemental missions assigned to the 403rd. The decision to get the 401st up and running first, while logical and necessary, slowed progress on the 403rd EPW camp. The delays included both anticipated delays, for example, delays attributable to the prioritization of engineering support and Class IV supplies, and the tasking to provide personnel to the 401st. However, some of the delays and problems were not anticipated and were not intentional. For example, equipment, material and supplies that were sent to the East site for both camps never found their way past the 401st to the 403rd, which was located behind the 401st. The equitable distribution of scarce resources remained a problem until the 800th established a logistic coordination center, LCC, in mid-February.

f. An advance party of the 403rd moved to the field site near As Sarrar on 22 January 1991, using vehicles borrowed from subordinate guard units. Since the 403rd had no tentage in country the advance party lived in a cinder block building under construction at the East site. The remainder of the 403rd was shuttled to the EPW site as transportation and tentage became available. The command and operations elements of the camp were all in place by 28 January 1991.

g. The 864th Engineer Bn completed its survey of the 403rd EPW site on 23 January 1991, the day after the 403rd arrived at the As Sarrar site. Construction of the camp was begun by the 403rd advance party and forward guard companies on 25 January 1991. Maximum use was made of engineer assets when they were not needed at the 401st site and civilian construction skills of 403rd and guard company personnel. Construction material remained a problem until the end.

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h. Although the 403rd accepted EPW on 17 February, construction was not completed. Gates, including sally ports, were a particular problem. Material for the gates had to be scrounged and the unit lacked the equipment needed to install the gates in the soft sand and hard sandstone. The gates and sally ports eventually constructed were satisfactory for temporary use but would not have been acceptable over the long term. As originally constructed each EPW camp consisted of 30 compounds spacially organized into three enclosures of ten compounds each. However, the compounds were not connected by barrier material. Even while housing EPW, the 403rd continued to work on compound security. The exteriors of all compounds in an enclosure were tied together with concertina. Sally ports were constructed and concertina wire laid within the commons area of each enclosure. Permanent lighting was not completed until 23 February 1991, six days after we first began accepting EPW.

i. The goal of the 403rd was to have the camp operational before the start of the ground war. This timeline was met. However, in order to meet the timelines, resources of both the 403rd and all subordinate units had to be dedicated to the construction of the camp. This included all vehicles, material and personnel. The construction process took its toll on all units involved and was accomplished at the expense of improvements in life support areas for US personnel.

j. The end of the ground war was followed by a large influx of EPW. The 403rd received 9,853 EPW in a seven day period beginning on 27 February. With this influx internal priorities shifted from construction of the camp to life support for the EPW and inprocessing operations. The rate at which EPW were arriving was too fast for inprocessing to keep up. Compounds were challenged to get tents up fast enough to keep the EPW covered at night and mess operations started to keep them fed. The initial shortage of tentage was solved in early March. Food problems were solved through the establishment of a supplemental mess to prepare food for the compounds. The supplemental mess was initially set up by the 400th MP Camp. EPWs were used as cooks and KPs. The supplemental mess was only operational for about five or six days, but it was a critical five or six days.

k. Sewage removal and water distribution remained problems. The water problem was made more difficult to manage because of a decision by supporting engineers not to construct roads around and through the enclosures (a resource allocation decision). Without a working water system all water had to be delivered by truck. The soft sand made trafficability in parts of the camp impossible except for four wheel drive vehicles. Much time was wasted and energy expended pulling two wheel drive water vehicles out of soft sand. In retrospect the water problem could have been most easily been solved with a complete TWIDS System to include both the wholesale components, which were on site, and the retail components which were not on site. The retail components include the two inch hosing and fixtures needed to get water from the big line to the compounds. The sewage lines needed to be buried and laid out with a 4% downhill slope towards the lagoon.

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1. The inprocessing of EPW was one of the real success stories associated with the operation. The 403rd met the 800th goal of 500 EPW per day during the first 24 hours of inprocessing. A total of 9,647 EPW were processed during a nine-day period which doubled the Brigade goal (1,075 per day contrasted with the goal of 500). Toward the end of the inprocessing period the Brigade goal was nearly being tripled as the 403rd achieved processing rates of 1,400 per day over the last three days. These rates were achieved while still maintaining the laudatory accuracy rate initially established at much lower processing rates and while still fully processing all EPW. Processing included a complete inventory of EPW property; EPW were thoroughly searched; showered; weighed; given a physical by a MD; given new clothes; deloused; processed; fingerprinted; photographed; and finally, given an ID card. The way the 403rd inprocessing center was organized was personnel heavy. It required the entire 420th processing company less a processing team assigned to hospital duty in the Khobar area. The entire 970th Guard Company (initially less elements assigned to the JIF Security mission) provided security for inprocessing operations. In order to keep the inprocessing operation running smoothly and efficiently, additional personnel had to be diverted from other functions. Extra medical personnel and a large number of personnel from the 403rd, including supply and medical personnel from HHC and 95B from the enclosures, were temporarily assigned to the inprocessing center. The 403rd also kept a command representative at the processing center 24 hours per day to address problems as they occurred and before they could result in serious delays in inprocessing.

m. Periodically during inprocessing the computer disks were shipped to the 403rd computer section where the EPW records were integrated into the central data base and a PWIS update disk prepared. An individual packet was also prepared for each EPW at this time. The EPW packets, which included all EPW documents, made outprocessing a simple procedure. Outprocessing involved building a manifest and then retrieving the packet of those EPW on the manifest.

n. One of the key elements in the accomplishment of the mission was effective use of Host Nation interpreter support. Interpreters played a key role during inprocessing. However, they also provided invaluable assistance during outprocessing; during transfers, particularly transfers to Saudi camps; in dealings with indigenous population; operations with the enclosures; and dealing with disturbances. The native interpreters also provided guidance on customs and procedures that enabled members of the 403rd to deal more effectively with the Iraqi EPW.

4. Planning considerations for future operations: The following items constitute lessons learned and recommendations for subsequent operation:

a) An intermediate battalion headquarters should be included in the Camp configuration. The MP PW Camp, as organized under MTOE 19256HAR01 dated 880531, is not able to act as a command and control HQ for eight companies while at same time planning for and running an EPW camp. This is

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particularly critical when the staff is forced to deal with camp construction issues and working through other significant issues, such as replacing mission essential equipment that was delayed.

b) If the camp is responsible for construction of an EPW facility it should have an engineer unit in DS; probably at least an augmented platoon. The camp should also be furnished a complete set of detailed blueprints for the camp and all major sub-systems. The plans should be approved by both an engineer command (technical adequacy) and higher MP command (security).

c) Computer support plans for EPW operation need to be continually reviewed and updated. The computers proved their worth during Desert Storm. They greatly facilitated inprocessing, accountability and outprocessing. However, some of the steps i.e., merges, prints, etc - were slow and could be speeded up with newer equipment and software.

d) Adequate provisions for field sanitation were a key to the success of the 403rd mission. Provisions for field sanitation are critical to success of any EPW operation. The PW Camp MTOE should be revised to reflect the importance of field sanitation. Changes should reflect both increases in the number of personnel assigned in areas of field sanitation and preventive medicine, and an increase in the rank structure.

e) Transportation was a major problem throughout the operation. This includes transportation of EPW, Class IV supplies, and Class I and II supplies for EPW. EPW Camps should have a DS transportation unit. The size and configuration of the transportation unit should be tailored to the specific mission requirement.

f) Command emphasis remains one of the keys to success of any mission. The 403rd was directly involved in the supervision of, and overall operation of the inprocessing center, enclosure operations and outprocessing. The 146th MP BN supervised guard company operations.

g) The 403rd supported a number of important missions that were not related to the primary EPW Camp mission. These missions included airport security, hospital guards, customs, JIF, and ASP security. The 403rd was also required to provide a large number of personnel to support other functions such as LCC, drivers and assistant drivers for Host Nation support, drivers and assistant drivers to support EPW movements and personnel to support US operations. While all these missions were important, they diverted personnel away from our primary mission of securing, accounting for, and housing EPW. During the critical period from 27 February through 8 March, when the inprocessing center was operating 24 hours per day, personnel shortages were critical. One of our six guard companies was permanently stationed in Khobar. One other company was assigned to supplemental missions. The remaining guard companies were supporting the enclosures, (a company minus per enclosure), supporting inprocessing, and supporting the escort mission. The soldiers worked long hours and were spread thin. In future operations camps should not be

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assigned supplemental missions and should not be tasked with providing drivers, LCC duties, etc. For this operation it was necessary. If the war had been prolonged or EPW camps had tried to operate for an indefinite period, this strategy would have taken its toll and the risks associated with it would have become unmanagble.

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Commanding

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Annex A (Success of Mission) to 403rd MP PW Camp
Desert Shield/Desert Storm After Action Review

1. Issues: Success

a. Title: Success of the 403rd in the accomplishment of the EPW mission.

b. Findings(s): The 403rd MP PW Camp successfully accomplished its mission. The 403rd successfully mobilized and deployed to Saudi Arabia, constructed an EPW Camp, accepted EPW; inprocessed the EPWs; fed the EPW; housed the EPW; met the standards for sanitation; outprocessed EPW and dismantled the EPW Camp.

2. Discussion:

a. The 403rd MP PW Camp was mobilized on 6 December and given the mission to establish and operate an EPW Camp for up to 12,000 EPW and, upon order, expand the camp to hold up to 24,000 EPW. This mission was accomplished. The 403rd mobilized, deployed, constructed an EPW Camp, received, processed, housed and fed secured and outprocessed approximately 10,000 EPW. The 403rd was not required to expand the camp to 24,000 EPW but, within the limitations discussed later in this report, the capacity of the Camp could have been increased significantly. Critical tasks that were successfully completed in order to accomplish the mission are listed below.

b. Mobilization: The 403rd was mobilized 6 December by Headquarters, 5th US Army Order No 157-12 dated 3 December 1990. The unit deployed to MOB station, Fort Riley, Kansas on 10 December 1990. While at MOB Station the unit conducted required predeployment training and mission specific training. Both home station mobilization activities and the movement to MOB Station were conducted according to 403rd MOB file and movement plans. Mandated deployment training was coordinated through Readiness Group, Fort Riley and mission specific training was coordinated the United States Army Correctional Brigade. The mobilization, to MOB Station movement and MOB station training were accomplished without significant problems or delays.

c. Construction of EPW Camp: The EPW site survey was completed by the 864th Engineer Bn on 23 January 1991. Construction began on 25 January 1991. In spite of a number of problems discussed later in the report, the 403rd was able to accept EPW on 17 February 1991. Construction continued through approximately 1 March 1991. The construction focused on improved security. Additional concertina was added between compounds and within the commons area in each enclosure, gates and sally ports were built, and guard towers added. The construction was completed with minimum engineer support and while also supporting the construction of the 401st Camp. Maximum use was made of engineer assets when they were not needed at the 401st site, and the civilian construction skills of 403rd and guard company personnel.

d. Acceptance of EPW: Although the 403rd began accepting EPW on 17 February 1991, the most critical period for receiving EPW was 27 February

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through 5 March 1991. The 403rd received 9,853 EPW during this seven day period. Inprocessing was unable to keep up with this influx. Modifications had to be made in operations to accommodate the large numbers. There were also shortages in transportation assets, so vehicles had to be immediately returned to haul more EPW. The EPW, which arrived in groups of up to 1900, were unloaded and put directly into compounds nine and ten of Enclosure Two where they were given water, fed and secured. From this initial holding compound they were systematically moved to longer term holding compounds in either Enclosure Two or Enclosure Three. During the move they passed through a sally port. This was the first opportunity for a thorough search. It was critical to get the EPW off the vehicles, to get them fed (some had not eaten for several days), and identify those needing immediate medical treatment as quickly as possible. The procedures we used allowed us to secure and control the EPW with minimal risk. No serious incidents occurred during the critical seven day period. The one incident that potentially could have been serious, a disturbance over the distribution of food, was easily controlled. This was the only problem encountered during the operation.

e. Inprocessing: The 403rd was able to meet the 800th goal of processing 500 EPW per day during the first 24 hours of the critical inprocessing period. A total of 9,647 EPW were processed in less than a nine day period beginning at 1200 on 27 February 1991; a rate that more than doubled the Brigade goal. Toward the end of the nine day period the Brigade goal was nearly being tripled as the 403rd achieved processing rates of 1,400 EPW per day over the last three days. These rates were achieved while still maintaining the laudatory accuracy rate initially established at much lower processing rates and while still fully processing all EPWs. The processing included a complete inventory of EPW property; a thorough search; a shower; the EPW were weighed; given a physical by an MD; given new clothes; deloused; processed; fingerprinted; photographed; and given an ID card. Shortcuts recommended by National PWIS made the increase from approximately 1,000 per day to 1,400 per day possible. The shortcuts we implemented included fingerprinting thumbs only, instead of all fingers; and printing a two page summary of information on the Form 4237 instead of the complete Form 4237. We continued to issue EPW ID cards with photograph during inprocessing as an accountability control measure. The way the 403rd inprocessing center was organized was efficient. It was designed to move EPW quickly, however, it was also personnel intensive. In addition, to the 420th Processing Company, a guard company, the 970th was also assigned to the processing center. Extra medical personnel and a large number of personnel from the 403rd, including supply and medical personnel from HHC and 95Bs from the enclosures, were temporarily assigned to the inprocessing center to keep the processing line going 24 hours per day. The 403rd also kept a command representative at the processing center 24 hours per day to address problems as they occurred (before they became serious and caused delay) and to insure a consistent flow of EPW to and from the Enclosures.

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f. Feeding of EPW: The 403rd was able to feed Class A rations to EPW during the entire period the camp was operational. The biggest challenge was establishing mess operations in the compounds during the rapid growth in the EPW population beginning on 27 February 1991. This problem was resolved with the establishment of a supplemental kitchen than prepared food outside the enclosure. The food was transported to the compounds. The supplemental mess was initially set up by the 400th MP PW Camp. EPWs were used as cooks and as KPs. Although the supplemental kitchen was only operational for about five or six days, it was critical to the success of the mission. It allowed the enclosures to get their own mess sections up and running. Two of the enclosures ran messes in each compound, one enclosure ran a consolidated mess for the entire enclosure. The EPW mess operations were closely monitored by 403rd Preventive Medicine/Field Sanitation personnel. Changes were made and cleanliness/sanitation improved each day the EPW messes were operational. German MREs were used as back-up to Class A rations and were used to feed EPW work details. During the entire period the 403rd was operational there was only one occasion on which back-up rations had to be fed, and that was caused by a combination of missed Class A rations delivery and shortage of water for cooking. Prepackaged rations were used when the EPW first arrived in Camp (they were handed rations as they got off the bus) and when they left (as lunches for the bus ride to the Saudi Camp). During the period the supplemental kitchen was operational there were occasions when arriving EPW were fed hot Class A rations. Saudi rations were fed to departing EPW when available to avoid problems with religious beliefs.

g. Housing EPW: Each EPW was given blankets, a sleeping mat and placed in a tent. Initially tentage was a problem. The 4x4 meter tents being used were inefficient; they could only hold six to eight EPW. Too many had to be set up to house the large number of EPW arriving each day; consequently some EPW were forced to spend one night out side. The problem was solved when 10x20 meter tents became available. All EPW could then be placed in a tent.

h. Sanitation: The 403rd was able to effectively manage sanitation problems. The two 918 assigned to the 403rd effectively supervised sanitation in the compounds. They identified both problem and potential problems, presented alternatives for dealing with problems to commanders, and monitored implementation of their recommendations. The enclosures successfully implemented these recommendations. Consequently conditions remained satisfactory in the compounds and improved daily.

i. Outprocessing: The procedures followed during inprocessing and the SOP followed by P&A of the 403rd facilitated outprocessing. These procedures included putting together individual packets for EPW as soon after inprocessing as possible. The packets which were all completed before outprocessing started, included all EPW documents. Therefore, outprocessing involved building a manifest, retrieving the packets

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for those EPW on the manifest, and organizing EPW in the enclosures by manifest. As the EPW were outprocessed their bracelets were compared with ID cards and the ISN on the front of the packets. After some initial adjustment this procedure went smoothly and quickly.

j. Breakdown of Camp: As EPW left, the 403rd asked for and received permission to use EPW labor to breakdown the compounds vacated. The breakdown proceeded systematically. Enclosure One was the first to be empty and was completely dismantled by EPW work details before the next enclosure was empty. By the time the last EPW were transferred out on 27 March 1991, two enclosures were completely dismantled and the remaining enclosure was down to two compounds.

k. Integration of Interpreters: One of the important factors in the success of the mission was the effective use of Host Nation interpreter support. Interpreters played a key role during inprocessing. However, they also provided invaluable assistance during outprocessing; during the transfer of EPW, particularly transfers to Saudi Camps; in dealing with the indigenous population; operations within enclosure; and dealing with disturbances. The native interpreters also provided guidance in customs and procedures that enabled members of the 403rd to deal more effectively with the Iraqi EPW.

3. Recommendations: Specific problems encountered during the mission and recommendations for solving those problems are addressed later in the report (as separate issues).

Annex B (Obligations Under International Law) to 403rd MP PW Camp
Desert Shield/Desert Storm After Action Review

1. Issue: Obligations under international law.

a. Title: Documentation of US and Coalition Forces activities regarding operations in execution of national obligation under international law.

b. Finding(s):

1) Overall, US forces either met or exceeded obligations to EPW under international law. The EPW were generally given humane treatment and the best care (sufficient and well prepared food, excellent medical care, adequate water, and satisfactory living conditions) possible under the circumstances.

2) The few instances of documented abuse were dealt with swiftly and firmly.

3) Some evidence of exploitation of EPW i.e. selling MREs, cigarettes etc. was found, particularly prior to their arrival at the EPW Camp. Measures were taken to prevent exploitation during EPWs stay in Camp and disciplinary action taken against individuals dealing with, but not necessarily exploiting, EPW.

4) Frequent ICRC visits uncovered no serious problems with the treatment of EPW. One minor problem identified by ICRC was the fact that EPW were being disciplined by being isolated in areas in which there was no protection from the sun. This problem was immediately rectified.

5) Although there is no evidence of abuse in any enclosure, disciplinary action taken against EPWs varied from enclosure to enclosure. However, discipline actions were consistently enforced within enclosures.

2. Discussion: EPW received very good treatment from US Forces at both Corps Cages and Camps. This treatment made them easy to manage. Meals were adequate, there were no incidents of food related illnesses. EPW were provided adequate water. They received good medical care either by Iraqi doctors in the enclosure, by Iraqi doctors at the EPW Camp Aid Station, or at the 300th Field Hospital. EPW were, for the most part treated humanely, by compound and guard personnel. The two documented incidents of abuse resulted in Article 15 UCMJ and subsequent reduction of the soldiers involved. Some incidents of exploitation of EPW before they arrived at Camp were documented. These included selling MREs and cigarettes at inflated prices, and the unlawful confiscation of property and money. When it became apparent that soldiers assigned to the 403rd were dealing with EPW, the soldiers were disciplined and command direction forbidding dealing with EPW put out. This should not have been necessary because the topics were covered in training at Fort Riley. No evidence was found of profiteering. No information is available on treatment of EPW by Coalition Forces.

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3. Recommendation:

a. Although the handling of EPW was generally humane and consistent with both the Geneva Convention and international law, both enclosure and guard personnel should receive periodic refresher training in the obligation to EPW and in EPW management.

b. The unit SOP regarding the discipline of EPW should be revised and followed. This would insure the consistent administration of discipline across enclosures.

Annex C (EPW Flow to Camp) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1.c. Issues:

a. Title: Logistics transportation, capture point, EPW handling and flow of EPWs to and from Camp.

b. Finding(s):

1) The most severe shortcoming was transportation assets. The assets available for EPW transportation was marginal at best.

2) The Escort Guard MTOE (19-047) did not provide adequate personnel and equipment in this scenario.

3) The rate at which EPW arrived as many as 3,900 in one day, required drastic modification in unit SOP for new arrivals.

2. Discussions:

a. EPW were transported from Marine Central Holding Cage to 403rd MP PW Camp, from the 403rd MP PW Camp to Saudi POW Camp at An Nairiyah, Artiwyah, and Hafar Al Batin and to the 301st MP PW Camp near Hafar Al Batin.

b. The 346th MP Co was tasked to escort EPW's from MARCENT Holding Cage to the 403rd Camp. A platoon sized element was deployed to the MARCENT Holding Area to ensure quick turnaround of EPW's.

c. EPW's were transported by buses and five and ten ton trucks. The buses and trucks were obtained from the Saudi Government and were a solution to the lack of transportation as US transportation assets were not available. US transportation was dedicated to hauling supplies forward with a quick return. Doctrinal backhaul was not a viable option in this theatre. US Marines utilized M915's and flatbeds with sides and CH47 helicopters as a quick fix. The flatbed trucks evacuated a large number of EPW (up to approximately 2,000 in one group) and helicopters approximately 400 more in two missions. The use of CH-47's was a one time only mission during EPW evacuation to the 403rd Camp. The buses and five-ten ton trucks previously mentioned were in a state of poor repair. They were old and poorly maintained. Neither the 800th MP BDE LCC (East Camp) nor the MP PW Camps had parts to maintain these vehicles or proper recovery vehicles to recover them as they broke down. These conditions caused great attrition of transportation resources. Additional resources were obtained to continue the mission.

d. The 346th MP Co (EG) MTOE did not have adequate transportation assets. The 19-77 (Combat MP) assets were not available for convoy security. The 346th had to provide their own guards for escorting EPW's and convoy security. Additional vehicles were provided to the Escort

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Guard Company from the Camp's subordinate guard companies and the Camp's Motor Pool. This was the only option available. Attrition was not a problem.

e. The lack of transportation assets to support the transportation of EPW placed a severe strain on the personnel resources of the Camp. In order to transport EPW with the buses and trucks provided, it was necessary for both the 346th MP Co (EG) and the MP Guard Companies to provide drivers and assistant drivers, as well as escort guards. As the numbers of EPW to be transported increased and the distances of the trips became longer a significant number of personnel were committed to this effort. If EPW had continued to arrive at the 403rd Camp. The Camp's ability to accomplish its mission would have been severely restricted by a personnel shortage. In any future operation a better way of transporting EPW must be found, which does not task Camp personnel.

f. The logistical support for US and EPW personnel during transportation was adequate as a whole, logistics for US personnel was maintained by the companies and Camp. Rations water, and fuel were readily available. Fuel was readily available at the Camps and convoy support centers on the MSR's.

g. The EPW's were supported as humanely as possible. The only severe problem was that EPW's coming from the MARCENT Cage were not provided with adequate water and rations. This caused considerable problems for the escort guards. The EPW's were given food, water, clothing and blankets upon arriving at the 403rd, and, when they were transferred from the 403rd to other POW Camps.

h. In summary, the transport mission was handled in a manner which resulted in no loss of life or serious injury.

i. EPW arrived in groups of from 600 to 1,900. It was not practical to process the EPW through a Sally Port. It simply took too long. The transportation needed to be turned around. Therefore arriving EPW were unloaded into compounds nine and ten of Enclosure Two where they could be given water, fed and given a blanket (they typically arrived late at night when it was extremely cold). Once they had been secured in compounds nine and ten, they were taken out in manageable groups, searched and processed into compounds where they stayed until they could be fully inprocessed and assigned an ISN. These procedures provided for as humane treatment of the EPW as possible under the circumstances, while at the same time providing for maximum security.

3. Recommendations:

a. ARCENT should either place US transportation assets OPCON to the MP EPW Bde or procure equipment, i.e., buses or trucks, that were mission capable. This would ensure consistent mission results. Also, needed would be the capabilities to maintain the equipment.

Annex C (EPW Flow to Camp) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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b. Department of the Army should review the 19-047 MTOE for MP Escort Guard Companies. Review and add personnel and equipment (vehicles, weapons) to make the MTOE more flexible to meet mission requirements.

c. The holding area at the inprocessing center needs to be configured to house EPW for up to 72 hours while they are awaiting processing. This will not be an answer when the numbers of EPW approach those encountered during Desert Storm. In such cases units will need to adjust as best they can.

Annex D (EPW Camp Construction) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Issue: PW Camp Construction and Major Problems.
2. Title: Construction of the EPW camp area to include berms, barrier wire, gates, lighting, water, sewer and prefabricated guard towers.
3. Findings: Areas of major shortcomings in the construction of the EPW camp included:

a. Lack of engineer equipment and support for dirt moving, driving rebar fence poles, road building and other construction. This type of equipment was always at a premium as it was spread between the 401st and 403rd camps. Often during construction, the 403rd had to do without this equipment support.

b. The sewer system had a waste input system that was not user friendly, causing stoppage problems plus numerous pipe leaks which were likely caused by inadequate installation or poor selection of piping material.

c. The water system had incompatible fittings and, like the sewer pipe, was subject to leaks at joints caused by poor installation or poor selection of piping materials.

d. The lighting layout did not cover areas between compounds very well.

e. Prefabricated wooden guard tower pieces required additional modification to erect properly.

f. No concrete was available to adequately anchor gate posts.

g. Detailed plans and blueprints with specifications were not available for the Camp and major subsystems of the camp, water, sewage and lighting. This placed the camp in the position of weighing alternatives for each system. The deliberations slowed the construction process and did not always result in the best system.

4. DISCUSSION: The normal allocation of engineer unit equipment and labor to construct two 12,000 to 24,000 prisoner camps is unknown at our level. However, the single engineer platoon that was allocated to construct two camps, (the 401st and 403rd MP) was inadequate. The MP soldiers of both camps and subordinate guard companys were a ready source of labor and effectively supplemented the engineers. They made the plan work as is. Had more equipment for earth moving been available, the 403rd camp could have been completed a week to ten days earlier with better trafficability inside the camp area and the road to the camp would have been completed in time to be used for transporting prisoners to the processing area. The Engineer Platoon air compressor and accompanying tool set, specifically the air hammer to drive rebar fence poles for the triple standard concertina wire, is a good example of the difference equipment can make in construction progress.

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A platoon of MPs using two compressors to drive the rebar poles could haul material and install ahead of four MP platoons actually installing the concertina with the four platoons able to lay wire on a total of six compounds per day. All 30 compounds could go up in five days with two air compressors and hammers running or ten days with one compressor set operating.

b. The sewer system design, although good in theory, failed because of improper pipe materials, installation methods and/or because of design unfamiliarity with EPW camp operations. The design called for a human waste receptacle in the interior of the compound for control and convenience. However, these were constantly plugged by prisoners throwing bottles and other trash into the receptacles. Several pipe joints leaked and as they were repaired, other joints began to leak. The pipe was installed under supervision of the supporting engineer platoon and in accordance with this plan, so installation practice should have been adequate. Had the pipe been buried instead of laid upon the ground, the joints may have not leaked with this additional support.

c. The water system was good in concept as it provided water to each prisoner compound. The pipe selected was the same type and manufacture as the sewer pipe but in small (2" and 4") sizes as opposed to the 6" pipe for the sewer. It suffered the same problem as sewage pipes. The joints leaked. It was also installed above ground because lack of equipment needed to bury it. Again, had the pipe been buried with the resulting additional support on the pipe joints, leaking may not have been a problem. However, the worst problem about the water pipe design was the selection of a pipe with push together rubber gasket joints that had no readily available adapter fittings to connect to the standard Army TWIDS system. Therefore, the completed water line waited for about two weeks before it could be connected to the TWIDS system by means of a custom manufactured fitting. The user side of the system, which was to be a 3,000 gallon "onion skin" water storage bladder at each compound, was never connected to the water distribution system because no PVC to TWIDS "quick" coupling adapters could be found to make the connections. Recognizing the problem of not being able to connect the piping to the bladder, the PVC system was run directly into each compound and installed inside of the compound. The prisoner's liberal use of water left it puddled around creating a sanitation problem.

d. The security lighting system consisted of 36 light stands per enclosure, two fixtures per stand around the perimeter of the enclosure. The design layout did not provide for lighting to cover the areas between compounds, nor was the lighting as bright as desired. The diesel electric generator sets did not have a transfer switch to allow switching off the generator units rapidly if one went down. This switch was designed into the system but not available in time to be installed.

e. Prefabricated wooden guard towers were constructed as units and moved to the Camp. They were taken apart and delivered to the camp, but

Annex D (EPW Camp Construction) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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were not kept together or identified as units and could not be assembled as units. Therefore, predrilled bolt holes did not match up. The assembled guard platforms were so heavy they required heavy equipment, such as a crane, to lift them into place.

f. Concrete was not available for installation of gate posts. Enclosure and guard company personnel did not feel the heavy saw horse gates constructed by the engineers were adequate for security. Therefore, swing-type gates of lumber and barbed wire were constructed for each compound.

5. RECOMMENDATIONS:

a. Basic engineer equipment needed for construction of an EPW camp could also be used for camp sustainment projects. For example, a backhoe would be used for digging sumps for sanitation purposes or exposing buried utility line for repair. A bulldozer could be used for maintenance of berms and covering trash pits. A forklift or bucket loader could be used to move latrines, showers, etc. A Request for a change in the EPW Camp MTOE will be prepared for the 403rd MP PW Camp for basic pieces of engineer equipment such as a bulldozer, backhoe, bucket loader, an engineer compressor and tool set and the operators and mechanics for operation and maintenance (about six personnel). This equipment will make the field EPW Camp much less dependant on engineer unit support so combat engineers can be more available for combat support missions.

b. Whenever a piped sewer system is installed it should be buried, at least in a shallow trench, minimum of 18" deep. Clean out fittings with caps would be implaced to clear out, rod out stoppages. When the pipe is buried, minor leaks will not surface and be a sanitary problem, and it will also be protected from vehicle traffic that could damage it. The receiving recepticle to place human waste into the sewer must not be readily accessible to the prisoners to allow them to place foreign materials into the pipe. This recepticle should be fenced off inside a corner of the compound or placed outside the compound wire. The piping installed should be checked to be sure it and its joints are of the recommended type for a force main or a pressure piping system.

c. The water system should also be buried in a shallow trench when installed so as to avoid damage by vehicle traffic and to support the joints to reduce leaking at the joints. At no time, however, should the water pipe be placed in the same trench as the sewer. If the sewer piping has leaky joints dangerous cross contamination of the water system would be possible. If the water system was constructed entirely of TWIDS system components, it would be a very flexible system, and would be compatible with the standard water supply items. It could also easlily be connected to the 3,000 gallon onion skin bladders. This TWIDS system also would be much less susceptible to vehicle damage and would not need to be buried. Therefore, the primary recommendation would be to construct EPW camp water supply systems entirely of standard TWIDS assault line systems if at all possible.

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d. Lighting systems should be laid out by an experienced security person to ensure that light reaches all areas where security is considered important. Then the design engineer could calculate the number and size of lights needed to provide the required lighting candle power to the areas selected. In this particular situation within the 403rd MP PW Camp, the MPs were directly involved in the camp construction, coordination was effected early on with the engineers supervising the wiring so that the MPs could move the fixture to areas needing lighting before the lighting was hardwired to the main circuit. Also, when a second engine driven electric generator set is provided as backup power, a manual switch should be provided to switch the electrical circuit from one generator to the other as physically switching the main circuits from the buss bars of one unit to the other took almost an hour in daylight conditions which would take too long at night.

e. Prefabricated wooden guard towers should be packaged as a set or kit, e.g., parts banded together as soon as the prefabrication is complete so they fit together easily to include drilled bolt holes at time of assembly and erection.

f. Pre-mix concrete should be made available in theater for small projects such as setting the gate posts. In this particular case, the MPs of the 403rd MP PW Camp were able to tamp sand around the posts tight enough for a temporary installation. For sustained operations the tamped gate posts would not have stood up long enough and would have required replacement.

g. If the Camp is responsible for construction of an EPW facility, it should have an engineer unit in direct support; probably at least an augmented platoon. The Camp should also be furnished a complete set of detailed blue prints for the camp and all major sub-systems. The plans should be approved by both an Engineer Command (technical adequacy) and the higher MP Command (security review).

Annex E (Transfer of EPW to Saudi Control) to 403rd MP PW Camp
Desert Shield/Desert Storm After Action Review

1. Title: Transfer of EPWs to Saudi custody.

2. Findings:

a. Inadequate guidance/coordination from MP Advisory Teams concerning transfer procedures at the Saudi Camps.

b. Reorganization of EPW files from ISN sequence to grouping by compounds, led to difficulties in locating records in a timely manner.

c. Lack of adequate transportation resources (buses) prevented the camp from meeting Brigade missions on several occasions.

d. Short fuse mission warnings from Brigade.

3. Discussions:

a. MP Advisory Teams - As transfers occurred, the Saudi camps continued to change their administrative requirements. Examples are as follows:

1) They requested three copies of manifest instead of one.

2) We had to have separate roster for each bus.

3) The EPWs had to be loaded on the bus by ISN sequence on the manifest.

4) The 301st Camp required the last name of the EPW to be written on the outside of the records.

Guidance from the Advisory Team was sporadic and incomplete. We never found out about the above changes in requirements until after the 346th Escort Guard returned from a mission.

b. Organization of EPW files - We had initially organized EPW files by ISN sequence number. We then reorganized the files by compound within enclosures. Due to the short time sequence given for transfer preparation, we had great difficulty in finding the EPW files. During the early transfers we often had to ship prisoners without records.

c. Transportation support - The LCC did not have adequate buses to support simultaneous transfers of EPW from both the 403rd and 401st. This lack of buses led to failure to support Brigade mission objectives. (Example: Brigade would want 1,100 EPWs transferred and we only had transportation assets to support a mission of 800.)

d. "Short Fuse" mission requirements - We frequently received short time suspense missions from the 800th to transfer large numbers of EPWs the next morning. These mission requirements did not take into account the following:

Annex E (Transfer of EPW to Saudi Control) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1) Adequacy of transportation support.

2) Amount of computer time required to generate a manifest (up to 8 to 10 hours including both input and printing based on the size of the groups we were shipping).

3) Amount of time required for enclosures to sequence EPWs by the manifest and stage them.

4) Amount of time to pull and arrange EPW records by manifest.

4. Recommendations:

a. MP Advisory Teams need to be more pro-active in identifying requirements for transfers and communicate those findings to the camps prior to transfers.

b. EPW files must be organized in ISN sequence number to facilitate ease of access.

c. The Brigade G-4 needs to provide more transportation support for EPW transfers.

d. The Brigade G-3 needs to provide more lead time for transfer preparation.

Annex F (EPW Medical Considerations) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title:

- a. Medical considerations in processing of EPWs located in hospitals.
- b. Handling of Deceased EPW remains.

2. Findings:

- a. No SOP for processing EPWs located in hospitals delayed initial assessment, appropriate segregation and subsequent treatment.
- b. No SOP for handling EPW remains was fortunately not an issue. However an SOP is needed prior to operations.

3. Discussions:

a. Several unforeseen problems arose with the first hospitalized patient transfer. At the time, 24 hour EPW/CI inprocessing was under way, with many unprocessed prisoners held in enclosure holding areas. As such, though minimal, prior provisions in regard to "special prisoners" were unaddressed. I hadn't foreseen the inevitable need for immediate initial assessment and segregation for potential daily care. The enclosure commander also wanted written assumption of liability for the previously hospitalized EPWs.

b. The initial hospitalized EPW transfers (relatively small, approximately 20 EPWs) arrived, were segregated into the administration area, provisions for quarters made, and a guard stationed. The following day, follow up assessment and treatment plans were made. Included in the necessary care plan was daily ambulance transport from the enclosure compound to the 300th Field Hospital minimal care tent (within the EPW Camp). Appropriate forms for liability were filed.

c. Though resolutions were timely, the above protocol could have been established prior to initiation.

d. Though handling of EPW remains was fortunately not an issue, preliminary plans were discussed. Plans included initial isolation, immediate ISN number assignment, and transfer by available ambulance (403rd or 300th Field Hospital). All personal items would be tagged and the remains delivered to the 300th Field Hospital. Though written protocol is unavailable, it is assumed appropriate paperwork will be filed by the attached medical facility.

3. Recommendations:

a. The camp surgeon should establish a written SOP for processing EPWs located in hospitals prior to camp operation to include: Immediate physical assessment on arrival, prior separate quarters arrangement and designated ambulance service. This will identify immediate medical problems as well as insure appropriate followup care.

Annex F (EPW Medical Considerations) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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b. The camp surgeon should establish a written SOP on the handling of EPW remains prior to camp operation to include: initial ISN number assignment, appropriate personal item tagging, and transport to the attached medical facility.

Annex G (Repatriation Process) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: Repatriation
2. Findings: N/A
3. Discussion: The 403rd was never involved in repatriation procedures. During the early part of March 1991, the ICRC sent a team to have all EPWs fill out repatriation cards using Enclosure interpreters to facilitate. This process was accomplished in four days. However, we then began effecting transfers to the Saudi Camps.
4. Recommendations: N/A

Annex H (War Crimes Investigation) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Issues:

a. Title - War Crime Investigation of EPW.

b. Finding(s):

1) The S-2 Section was not responsible for interviewing EPW or determining criteria for interrogations.

2) The JIF was integrated into the 403rd inprocessing center. They had the opportunity to interview each or any EPW. Booths for JIF personnel were provided as the last station in inprocessing.

3) The 13th POB did conduct interviews in an attempt to identify war criminals.

2. Discussions:

a. The 800th Bde G-2 did forward a list of names and ranks of possible war criminals to this section. Our personnel immediately checked all computer entries for cross matches, but results were negative.

b. The 13th POB requested and received four interpreters from this section to be dedicated to their interviewing mission inside the enclosures.

c. Results of JIF or 13th POB investigations were not made known to the S-2 Section.

3. Recommendations: In this scenario all the proper assets were in place to more completely interview and interrogate EPW suspected of war crimes. However, the fluid nature of the flow of EPW did not allow for complete screening. We recommend a more comprehensive effort be placed at the initial capture points and Corps Holding Cages to identify suspects before they have the time or opportunity to alter their identity.

Annex I (Role of ICRC) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: Role of International Committee of the Red Cross in EPW Program.
2. Findings: There were no problems of significance.
3. Discussion:
 - a. The Red Cross should carry extra repatriation cards and capture cards. The numbers of EPW grew so rapidly that additional cards were needed but this was a minor concern.
 - b. Cooperation was evident on both sides and interaction went very smoothly on all matters.
4. Recommendations: N/A

Annex J (Logistical/Transportation Support) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: US Support

2. Findings:

a. Inadequate support units and supplies.

b. Supplies and equipment allocated to Corp units and EPW mission received a very low priority.

3. Discussion:

a. Logistical support was 180 miles away. Limited organic vehicle assets are in direct support of mission requirements. Soldiers received food of poor quality and selection. Rations were delivered for seven days within sufficient refrigeration assets available. Clothing could not be replaced when worn out or damaged. Uniforms made unserviceable during the intallation of concertina could not be replaced. Repair parts not available to unit or direct support maintenance unit.

b. Corps units received allocated supplies and equipment. Units supporting the EPW mission did without.

4. Recommendations:

a. Theater Army "support slice" be provided each site containing two MP PW Camps consisting of 2,400 - 3,000 US personnel and equipment. It would provide/obtain necessary supplies and services to support mission.

b. See above.

Annex J (Logistical/Transportation Support) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: Host Nation

2. Findings:

- a. Rations and cooking utensils started short.
- b. Simultaneous arrival of EPWs, tents and clothing.
- c. Commercial equipment not suited to field environment.
- d. Commercial equipment in poor mechanical condition.

3. Discussion:

a. Command underestimated quantities of rations and cooking utensils. It took several days to obtain/request sufficient rations and utensils. Ordering of rations and equipment was a three step process taking several days.

b. Simultaneous arrival of EPWs and supplies required exhaustive effort and inevitable conflicts between limited resources. Material handling equipment (MHE) support was insufficient.

c. Leased Host Nation commercial equipment was welcomed and useful, but was not capable of working in soft sand.

4. Recommendations:

a. Overestimate all ration and equipment requirements. Cooking utensils broke or were unsuitable, leading to delays in food preparation. Food storage, preparation and serving in a field location resulted in losses greater than normally expected. Refrigeration repair should be "local purchase" and done without delay. Camp Food Service supervisors be granted the authority to order, purchase and obligate funds to take corrective action.

b. Theater Army should provide tactical MHE support to facilitate rapid distribution of supplies. Stock pile supplies prior to EPW arrival.

c. Host Nation provide equipment suitable for field environment.

Annex J (Logistical/Transportation Support) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: US and Host Nation Transportation Support

2. Findings:

a. Unwillingness/inability to provide non-corp units transportation assets.

b. Host Nation transportation assets required unit personnel.

3. Discussion:

a. Units scheduled movement to field site with "supporting" transportation units. Requests were postponed or canceled. Units resorted to limited organic and borrowed assets.

b. Transportation assets furnished by Host Nation were mechanically unsound, and non-repairable. Unit personnel were utilized to drive vehicles.

4. Recommendations:

a. A Theater Army Support Group "slice" include a medium truck segment.

b. Host Nation trucks be provided with driver recovery assets and a maintenance contract. Transportation of EPWs be a Theater Army responsibility.

Annex K (EPW Accountability) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: EPW accountability and reporting systems (Prisoner of War Information System)

2. Findings:

a. The PWIS-2 system did not allow for assignment of EPWs by compound during inprocessing.

b. Failure on the part of the camp to obtain an uninterrupted power source for the computers seriously degraded timely response to missions.

c. The PWIS-2 system was very slow in completing uploads, transfers and Ad Hoc queries.

d. Lack of modems and commercial phones had an impact on timely accountability reporting of EPWs.

e. Accountability of EPWs evacuated through medical channels at King Fahd Military Hospital was inadequate.

3. Discussion:

a. Assignment of EPWs by compound - During the inprocessing phase of the mission, we could only assign EPWs by enclosure. This caused problems in two areas:

1) Total resolution of EPW population counts almost never matched between the computer and the enclosure.

2) Enclosure personnel had difficulty in sequencing the EPWs by bus increments on transfers. EPWs on one movement were often scattered throughout several compounds.

b. An uninterrupted power source/slowness of PWIS-2 - Lack of an uninterrupted power source had no impact with a small EPW population. However, as the population grew into the thousands, each transaction required more time on the computer. Examples of these transactions are:

Internee Strength Report
Transfer Orders
Uploads

Lack of an uninterrupted power source caused us to lose six hours or more of computer processing as generator power was shifted. The slowness of the PWIC-2 system degraded preparation time for transfer missions.

c. Lack of modems/medical accountability - We were tasked by the 800th to establish a cell of the 420th MP Company at King Fahad

Annex M (Communications) to 403rd MP PW Camp
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1. Title: Communications to 403rd MP PW Camp Command Report.

2. Findings:

a. In accordance with MTOE 19-256, the 403rd MP PW Camp is not authorized any communication assets other than three 31K soldiers and 12 TA 312 telephone's. These are two E-4 wire installers and one E-3 switchboard operator which work in the headquarters company.

b. This command had only one 31K assigned. A second 31K, was attached on 14 February 1991. There were ten TA-312's landline phones of which three were in maintenance, one TA-43 and one switchboard SB-22 and fifteen WD-1A wire rolls.

3. Discussions:

a. The equipment shortage was addressed in part when 50 PRC 127 hand held radios were requisitioned at Fort Riley our mobilization station, for anticipated use in the prisoner camp. After deployment, the communication concerns were addressed. It was recommended that a platoon size signal unit with all its equipment could provide the necessary communication. In addition, other types of communication (i.e., AN/PRC-127) were requested again to augment any landline phones (TA-312's) we did not receive.

b. After deployment to As Sarrar, the EPW camp site, the S-2 was appointed the 403rd MP PW Camp Communications Officer as an additional duty. The first objective was to ascertain what qualified personnel were present and the amount and type of communication equipment on hand. In addition, the status of any incoming communications. The mission of the communications section was to provide as many means of communication to all of the 403rd MP PW Camp and its subordinate units as possible.

c. The communication established was FM, tactical phones, and radios (AN-PRC-127). On 28 January 1991 a three line TAC telephone system was established by the 67th Signal Battalion which allowed the 403rd MP PW Camp to communicate on a secure line (See TAB A). The 146th MP Bn also received a TAC telephone system after their arrival.

d. Landline communication was established for the administrative site which included all sections of the 403rd MP PW Camp and seven units subordinate to the 403rd. A switchboard center was established in S-3 Operations through the addition of communication equipment from some of the subordinate units. The unit telephones did not arrive onsite until about 12 February 1991. When the 146th MP Battalion

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arrived 12 February with their communication assets they assisted the 403rd to establish proper landline phone switchboard coverage with the prisoner enclosures and guard towers as well as the inprocessing site of the prisoner camp.

e. The final landline communications established were in the administrative site, EPW Camp site (Enclosures), processing site, escort guard company, and, adjacent EPW Camp (401st MP PW Camp East Site) and the other subordinate units. All wire at the enclosure was set for hotloops and T-splices in each individual enclosure at the EPW camp site. A shortage of landline phones TA-312's and/or TA-43's and switchboards SB-22 was a major concern of the enclosures in the performance of their mission to house EPW's. Attached is a recommended list of communications equipment which would be needed to perform the mission. The majority of the work was done on foot due to the limited number of vehicles and priority to the EPWs. This was another concern. The distance from the administrative site to the EPW camp site was approximately three kilometers.

f. A shipment of AN/PRC-127's were received via the requisitions dropped at Fort Riley, but they were incomplete because of the several different configurations of charger units and battery packs provided with the radios. Most of battery packs required AA batteries and only a small quantity of these AA batteries could be found. AN/PRC-127's were issued to key staff sections, key personnel of 403rd, 420th Processing key personnel and enclosures to supplement communications not available. These hand held radios assisted the 403rd in the performance of our mission to inprocess, house and transfer EPW. However, because of limited capability of battery rechargers and of batteries themselves, only about thirty of these hand held radios could be put in service at any one time.

g. A shipment of ten AN/GRC-160 was received but was incomplete. Missing items were the power supply, batteries, mounts, and cables necessary to establish FM radio systems. We were able to establish FM communications through the availability of a small quantity of batteries for the AN/GRC-160 using the radio in its PRC-77 configuration. The 146th MP Bn and subordinate units provided additional support for the establishment of the FM system for connecting the 403rd Operations Section, 420th Processing Company and the three enclosure's administration centers, and, critical guard towers.

3. Recommendations:

a. A separate section should be established in the Staff to respond to the communication requirements of the command with additional landline, FM and hand held radios to set communications of a field temporary EPW Camp. As a minimum the section should consist of: 1 - signal officer (CPT), 1 - 31K40, E-7 Commo Chief, 2 - 31K30 E-5, installer team chiefs, 2 - 31K20, wire installer, and 3 - 31K20

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switchboard operators. If this is not possible then a detachment size signal unit should be attached to this command.

b. As a minimum, additional communications assets, beyond that authorized by Camp MTOE, are required for operation of the temporary theater EPW Camp as established by the 403rd MP PW Camp and subordinate units. Although communications were established for a hot loop telephone system between guard towers and the enclosure command posts via telephone assets of the MP Guard Companies and the 146th MP Bn Headquarters, no other MTOE assets were available for establishing andline communications to compound Administrative Areas and no MTOE back up communication assets, e.g. radio, were available for any of the above locations. The only reason the camp was able to function after significant numbers of prisoners were received was due to obtaining the additional non-MTOE URC-160 and PRC 127 radios mentioned in Paragraphs 2.f. and 2.g. above.

Annex N (Hospital PW Processing) to 403rd MP PW Camp
Desert Shield/Desert Storm After Action Review

1. Title: Hospital PW Processing

2. Findings:

- a. PWIS computer system beneficial.
- b. Hospital processing team can be larger if necessary.
- c. Amount of information collected on each prisoner has a serious impact on the time required for processing each EPW.
- d. Hospital team must be designated as their own camp.
- e. Prisoner property responsibility should go to the top Guard Company.
- f. Full time interpreter support is essential.
- g. MI/JIF must stay out of hospital channels.
- h. Liaison team is a waste of man power in the hospital channels.
- i. Prisoner hospitals should be in close proximity to each other.

3. Discussions:

- a. PWIS computer system made accountability and transfer of prisoners orderly.
- b. The hospital processing team was four people strong.
 - 1 - NCOIC
 - 1 - Computer Operator
 - 1-2 - Person Team for ProcessingIf it had been necessary the team could have been ten persons strong.
 - 1 - NCOIC
 - 1 - Computer Operator
 - 4 Two Person Teams
- c. When collection of all information is required the time needed is 20 minutes per prisoner per team. When minimal information is required it takes five minutes per prisoner per team.
- d. When hospital processing team is under another camp; accountability is difficult due to loss/time lapse of paperwork in distribution channels.
- e. When a prisoner is in hospital channels and is received at the hospital where they will be processed, they have already been searched

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at least twice. The time allowed for MP contact with prisoner is minimal due to the urgency of wounds to be treated.

f. When hospital interpreters are used and they are pulled from supporting the processing, the processing team comes to a near stand still.

g. MI/JIF is totally out of line in the hospital channels. When they came into our area of operation they literally halted progress. With 30,000 prisoners at other camps they surely had plenty to keep them busy.

h. The liaison team is not needed in the hospital channel. The NCOIC of the hospital team has the best accountability for the prisoners. There were a couple of times where the liaison team almost released a prisoner from US control to the Saudis. This is a classic case of the more times the same information is passed the more messed up it becomes.

i. Prisoner hospitals in closer proximity would alleviate the problem of the medics transferring prisoners to other hospitals without the NCOIC able to keep strict accountability.

4. Recommendations:

a. Keep and refine PWIS computer system.

b. Have one hospital processing team as opposed to many.

c. Determine what information is required for processing. This should be determined prior to receiving prisoners.

d. Designate each hospital processing team to its own camp.

e. Give prisoner property responsibility to the MP Guards in the hospital channels.

f. Attach interpreters to hospital processing team.

g. Prisoners of intelligence value will be identified and sent to a US PW Camp when they are able to be moved. MI/JIF can question them at that time.

h. DX liaison team and utilize the resources in a mannere that will benefit the mission.

i. Establish prisoner hospitals in close proximity to each other. (i.e., establish 207th Med Evac., 8th Med Evac., 201st Med Evac., 85th Med Evac. as prisoner hospitals then eliminate the 300th Med Evac. and any other prisoner hospitals). This would allow for one hospital processing team due to the close proximity.